SUDHA JAGATHEESH JAYANAND

MSc Cognitive Science, École Normale Supérieure, Paris
Email · Website · LinkedIn · Github

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Topics Computational cognitive science (decision-making, social learning, cross-cultural cognition); human–AI interaction; AI governance and policy.

Methods Machine learning, NLP, and text-as-data (transformer embeddings, clustering, text classification); quantitative analysis of large-scale and longitudinal panel data; cognitive modelling (Bayesian inference, reinforcement learning, evidence-accumulation models).

EDUCATION

08/2026 – 08/2028 **École Normale Supérieure – PSL** *Paris, France*
MSc in Cognitive Science (CogMaster)
- Specialisation: Cognitive Modelling, Neurotheory and AI. Minor: Data Science.
- Coursework: Cognitive Models and AI; Interpretable AI; Language; Representational Foundations of Mind; Perception, Memory, and Core Knowledge; Neural Modelling.

09/2021 – 07/2025 **London School of Economics and Political Science** *London, UK*
BSc in Psychological and Behavioural Science, First Class Honours
- Dissertation: *Performing Inclusion, Governing Exclusion? Investigating the Dynamics of Migrant Integration in the EU*. Supervisor: Dr Ben Tappin.
- Coursework: Statistics and Research Methods; Machine Learning (DS202); Simulation Modelling; Philosophy of Science; Social Economics and Policy.

08/2023 – 08/2024 **Stockholm School of Economics** *Stockholm, Sweden*
LSE Study Abroad (CIVICA exchange), Business and Economics. GPA: 4.43/5.0. Funded by the Turing Scheme.
- Coursework: Behavioural Finance; Data Science; Development Economics; Public Policy; Nationalism and Populism; Business Philosophy.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

06/2025 – 07/2025 **Quantitative Researcher, LSE GROUPS** *London, UK*
- Co-designed a study testing whether the partisan direction of corporate political donations predicts subsequent change in carbon intensity.
- Co-developed a Corporate Political Leaning index from OpenSecrets donation records, linked to Bloomberg emissions and financial data for 37 U.S. oil, gas and chemical firms across three electoral cycles (2017–2023).
- Estimated two-way fixed-effects panel models with firm-clustered errors and robustness checks; found Democratic leaning predicted lower carbon intensity outside Texas ($\beta = -0.42$, $p < .05$).

09/2022 – 03/2025 **Lab Manager and Research Assistant, Muthukrishna Lab** *London, UK*
Supervisor: Prof. Michael Muthukrishna, Professor of Economic Psychology
- Promoted from RA to Lab Manager in 10 months, managing 21-member lab and 10 concurrent grants; owned RA recruitment and onboarding across 45+ applicants.
- RA on the John Templeton Foundation–funded project on morality and ritual in Namibia: survey design, translation, data cleaning, financial and logistical support for field sites.
- Built a test set of Herero compound images for a machine-learning image classifier, and designed Gestalt and optical-illusion stimuli for the field study.
- Organised the Comity conference at LSE end to end; supported the literature search for a cross-cultural replication paper in *Communications Psychology* (2024).

08/2023 – 03/2025 **Student Researcher, CIVICA Engage Research Track** *London, UK & Stockholm, Sweden*
- Merged 5 cross-national datasets across 21 EU countries to model how integration policy and ruling-party rhetoric shape anti-immigrant sentiment.
- Combined OLS, moderation and Ward's hierarchical clustering to build a typology of EU integration regimes, showing that inclusive policy and public attitudes often diverge.

03/2022 – 07/2024 **Laidlaw Research Scholar, AI Governance and Public Wellbeing** *London, UK & Europe*
Supervisor: Dr Ioanna Gouseti
- Co-led a mixed-methods study testing whether AI policymakers and business leaders accurately anticipate AI's effects on public wellbeing.
- Conducted in-person fieldwork in Europe, interviewing EU AI Act policymakers (incl. an MEP and MEP advisers), business leaders and policy researchers.
- Led the quantitative arm (wellbeing survey, n = 105; multiple regression in R) and co-authored recommendations for evidence-based AI regulation.

08/2023 – 06/2024 **Research Associate, LSE Undergraduate Political Review** *London, UK*
- Built an NLP pipeline on a 7,000+ tweet corpus, combining LIWC psycholinguistic features with a Bayesian sentiment classifier, to track public perceptions of Zelenskyy's legitimacy across the Russo-Ukrainian war.

08/2023 – 06/2024 **Student Researcher, Nationalism and Populism** *Stockholm, Sweden*
Supervisor: Dr Jonas Brodin
- Designed and authored a 7-country study of right-wing populist support using World Values Survey Wave 7 (n = 14,952), with country-level logistic regressions and moderation models.
- Found that distrust of religious outgroups moderates the religiosity–populism link in the U.S., consistent with a social-identity account of religious mobilisation.

05/2022 – 09/2023 **Junior Researcher, Junior Researcher Programme** *Cambridge, UK*
Supervisor: Dr Daina Kosite
- Conducted literature reviews on health policy efficacy and interviewed mental health policy stakeholders at Oxford.

Leadership & Service

06/2026 – present **Co-Director, Oxford Computational Political Science Group** *Oxford, UK*
- Co-direct the group's computational social science research programme and contributor pipeline; designing a Research Engineer track for members with computer science backgrounds and conducting technical candidate interviews.
- Organising OCPSG's inaugural Oxford hackathon, securing partnerships and funding.

09/2022 – 11/2025 **Co-Founder and Editor-in-Chief, *Irrationale*** *London, UK*
- Founded LSE's first undergraduate research journal in the psychological and behavioural sciences; secured two consecutive years of Students' Union and departmental funding.
- Recruited 40+ student researchers, supervised 10 mixed-methods research groups from design to publication, and led editorial review.

03/2024 – 07/2025 Peer Supporter, LSE Student Wellbeing Service: confidential one-to-one support for students.

09/2022 – 07/2025 Student Academic Mentor, LSE: mentored undergraduates on assessments and assignments.

09/2021 – 07/2025 Student Academic Representative, PBS Staff–Student Liaison Committee; DS202 course representative.

Selected Computational Projects

2025 **Narratives of Distress: Unsupervised NLP on Mental Health Communities** *London, UK | GitHub*
- Analysed ∼800 expert-annotated posts from five mental health subreddits (Rani et al., 2024) to examine how users narrate self-concept, with spaCy pipeline adapted to informal text.
- Compared TF-IDF and Sentence-BERT clustering; BERT clusters aligned with community boundaries ($\chi^2 = 311$, $p < .001$) and differed in emotional tone (VADER).
- Profiled community-specific language using G^2 keyness, Jaccard lexical overlap and Louvain community detection on co-occurrence networks.

2025 **Forecasting Under Structural Breaks: Inflation and Monetary Policy** *London, UK | GitHub*
- Modelled 96 years of Yuan-dynasty inflation with regularised regression and engineered features; diagnosed a structural break that limited out-of-sample generalisation.
- Predicted Bank of England rate decisions with logistic regression and Random Forests, using time-series cross-validation, SMOTE and threshold tuning (macro F1 = 0.44).

2024 **Machine Learning for Housing Price Prediction** *Stockholm, Sweden | GitHub*
- Built an end-to-end prediction pipeline on 179,000 apartment sales merged with housing-association financial data (target encoding, k-means geographic clusters).
- Benchmarked linear regression, LightGBM, XGBoost and a tuned Keras network; grid-search-tuned LightGBM achieved 6.9% test MAPE, stable under 5-fold cross-validation.

Publications & Working Papers

Peer-reviewed and consortium work

2026 Priolo, G., Stablum, F., Vacondio, M., . . . , **Jagatheesh Jayanand, S.**, . . . , & Rubaltelli, E. "The Robustness of Mental Accounting Across 21 Countries." *Journal of Consumer Research*, advance article. doi:10.1093/jcr/ucag022 *(Multi-site replication consortium, 100+ authors.)*

2024 Acknowledged for literature search support in Schimmelpfennig, R., Spicer, R., White, C. J. M., . . . , Henrich, J., & Muthukrishna, M. "Methodological Concerns Underlying a Lack of Evidence for Cultural Heterogeneity in the Replication of Psychological Effects." *Communications Psychology*, 2, 93.

Student journal publications and working papers

2025 Sakovych, A. A., **Jagatheesh Jayanand, S.**, Adesanya, S., & Adesanya, I. "Hobbesian Sovereign in 21st Century Ukraine: Assessing the Impact of the Russo-Ukrainian War on Public Opinion of Volodymyr Zelenskyy." *LSE Undergraduate Political Review*, 8(1), 29–47.

2025 Tharakan, A., Mysore, A., Chan, H. C. H., Kong, H., Lu, S., **Jagatheesh Jayanand, S.**, & Wang, Z. "Donating Left, Polluting Right? The Impact of Corporate Political Leanings on Environmental Performance." Working paper, LSE GROUPS. *(Alphabetical order; equal contribution.)*

2025 **Jagatheesh Jayanand, S.** "Performing Inclusion, Governing Exclusion? Investigating the Dynamics of Migrant Integration in the EU." BSc dissertation, LSE (supervisor: Dr Ben Tappin).

2024 **Jagatheesh Jayanand, S.** "A Cross-Cultural Comparative Investigation into Populism, Anti-Elitism, and the Political Attitudes that Predict Right-Wing Populist Support." Research paper, Stockholm School of Economics.

2024 Brotons Batista, E., Dyonmez, I. L., & **Jagatheesh Jayanand, S.** "To What Extent Do Corporate and Governmental Organisations Involved in AI Accurately Incorporate Public Welfare into Their Leadership Decisions?" Laidlaw Scholars Research Report, LSE.

Presentations

All at the LSE Knowledge Beyond Boundaries Undergraduate Research Conference, London (selected presenter)

2025 *Performing Inclusion, Governing Exclusion?* (BSc dissertation). Visions for the Future panel.

2024 *Hobbesian Sovereign in 21st Century Ukraine.* Power and Politics panel.

2024 *Populism, Anti-Elitism, and Right-Wing Populist Support: A Cross-Cultural Investigation.* Power and Politics panel.

Policy & Professional Experience

09/2024 – 01/2025 **Head Consultant and Project Lead, London Strategic Consulting:** led a 5-person team on a UK market-entry engagement for Stardust Zone, reporting to the client CEO.

10/2022 – 06/2024 **Head of Marketing and Operations, LSE Economics Society & Business and Investment Group:** led rebranding and content strategy; +30% engagement.

07/2022 – 08/2022 **Summer Policy Consultant, Helen Bamber Foundation** *London, UK*
- Co-authored the policy report *Addressing Human Rights Concerns in Survivors of Trafficking and Torture* (2022), benchmarking the UK asylum system against comparator countries.
- Developed reform proposals on humanitarian visas, case triage, digitalisation, right to work and labour-market integration.

05/2022 – 08/2022 **Quantitative Analyst (Laidlaw internship), Resony Health** *London, UK*
- Analysed behavioural engagement data from 3,000+ users of an NHS-focused health-tech platform tackling waiting times (Python, AWS).

2024 **AI Impact Fellow, Effective Altruism LSE:** weekly discussions on AI policy and governance frameworks across the Global South, benchmarked against UN AI governance guidance.

2021 – 2022 **Journalist, LSE Amnesty International Society.**

Awards, Scholarships & Programmes

2025 Boston Consulting Group, Aspire Women's Programme: sole London undergraduate selected (4.8% acceptance).

2023 Turing Scheme Grant, covering living and travel costs for LSE study abroad at SSE.

2023 LSE Professional Services Award, for lab management in the Muthukrishna Lab.

2023 Best Performance Award and Cohort Rank 1 (Year 2), BSc Psychological and Behavioural Science, LSE.

2022 Laidlaw Leadership and Research Scholarship, LSE (1 of 25; £6,000 research + £1,500 fieldwork).

2022 Jury Prize for Best Pitch (Runner-up), Behavioural Science Foundations to Real-World Applications Forum, LSE.

2020 Yale Young Global Scholars, Politics, Law and Economics session (selected participant).

2020 Young Leaders for Active Citizenship (YLAC), selected student researcher; Outstanding Performer award.

Skills & Languages

Programming Python (pandas, scikit-learn, LightGBM, XGBoost, Keras, spaCy, Sentence-Transformers); R; Stata; LaTeX; Git/GitHub; Quarto; Qualtrics; LIWC; Tableau.

Languages Tamil, Telugu, English (native); Hindi (professional); French (A1).